CAREER GLITCH · SHORT · SIMPLE · NO BORING PARTS

BUSINESS CONSULTANT IN THE AI ERA

Owners don't buy advice. They buy someone who's already solved their exact problem.

★ TL;DR — ~$120K median — but this is an experience business: plan 2–4 years of building expertise, credentials, and licensing steps before the title pays. The catch: nobody hires an unproven consultant, and the market can smell it. ★

THE CAREER GLITCH TAKE

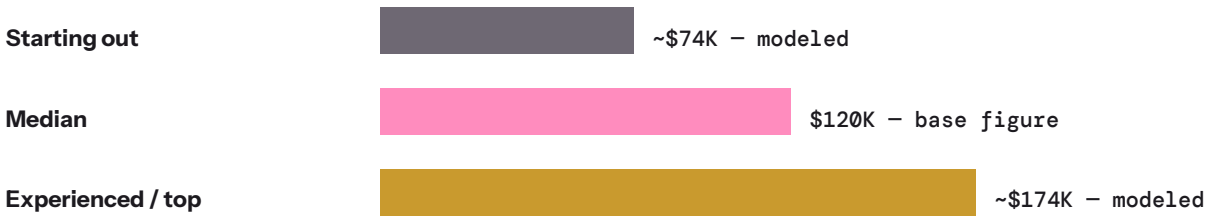
OUR TAKE: YES

MEDIAN ~$120K · TRAINING 2-4 years · AI RISK LOW · STATE LICENSE

- Consulting converts hard-won operational experience into high-rate advice.
- The product is pattern recognition: you've seen this failure before.
- AI doesn't threaten it much — clients pay for judgment in their specific mess.

The site's take, built from this profession's numbers in the Career Glitch base.

THE MONEY — LOOK AT THE BARS



The Career Glitch base figure for Business Consultant is a ~$120K median (compiled from U.S. Bureau of Labor Statistics, Occupational Outlook Handbook ranges). The starting and top bars are modeled around that median — orientation, not a promise. Pay swings hard by state, employer and experience: check live postings in your state before planning around any number.

WHAT DOES A BUSINESS CONSULTANT ACTUALLY DO?

- ✓ Diagnose business problems: money, process, people, growth
- ✓ Design the fix: plans, priorities, and measurable targets
- ✓ Work with owners and teams to implement, not just recommend

✓ Report results and adjust the plan as reality responds

Think: a doctor for businesses — diagnosis first, prescription second, and the fee reflects the years it took to tell the difference.

WHAT AI ALREADY TOOK (AND WHAT IT CAN'T)

THE ROBOT	THE HUMAN
AI benchmarks, drafts analyses, and builds decks fast. Research that took a week is now an afternoon.	Telling an owner the truth about their own business — and getting them to act on it — is pure human leverage. So is knowing which of ten problems matters first.

⚠ **This is not an entry-level job wearing a fancy title. Without a track record you'll starve politely. Build the expertise first; the consulting comes after.**

THE VIBE — IS THIS YOUR LIFE?

THE JOB IS	THE JOB IS NOT
✓ High rates and full autonomy once established ✓ Fully remote-capable for much advisory work ✓ Every client is a new business to learn	✗ Pipeline stress: you're always selling the next engagement ✗ Clients blame the plan when they skip the work ✗ Isolation — no team, no safety net

Good fit? You've run things, fixed things, and can explain why they worked — in numbers.
Bad fit? You're collecting the title before the experience. The market will correct you.

THE FORK — PICK ONE DOOR

DOOR A — CONSULTING FIRM	DOOR B — OPERATOR-TO-ADVISOR
Join a firm that sells your hours for you. You learn delivery methods on real engagements and build the case history your solo practice will later sell.	Consult from a real operating career: take your industry's problems as your niche and sell fixes you've personally implemented. Slower ramp, stronger credibility.

Smart move: Productize one narrow offer — a diagnostic audit with a fixed price and a defined output. It's far easier to buy than 'consulting' in the abstract.
Where you land after: Senior consultant, partner-track at a firm, or a boutique practice of your own.

YOUR ROADMAP — 6 STEPS

1	2	3	4	5	6
BUILD THE	LEARN THE	CREDENTIAL UP	MEET LICENSING	DELIVER UNDER	SELL YOUR

STEP 1 — Build the base expertise

YEARS 1-2

- Run real things: a team, a budget, a turnaround — gather scars and numbers.
- Document results obsessively; your future case studies live there.

STEP 2 — Learn the consulting method

MONTHS 6-18

- Study diagnostics: financial review, process mapping, market analysis.
- Practice turning findings into sequenced, costed plans.

STEP 3 — Credential up

FEES VARY · YEARS 1-3

- Earn the management-consulting credentials your market respects.
- Credentials don't replace a record — they frame it.

STEP 4 — Meet licensing requirements

STATE FEES · YEARS 2-3

- Some advisory services are regulated — complete your state's licensing and registration steps for the services you'll sell.
- Keep licenses, insurance, and continuing requirements current.

STEP 5 — Deliver under a flag

PAID · YEARS 2-3

- Consult inside a firm, or as an associate to an established consultant.
- Ship engagements end to end and collect measured outcomes.

STEP 6 — Sell your own engagements

WORKING · YEARS 3-4

- Package your narrow offer and price it on value, not hours.
- Your pipeline becomes the business — treat it that way.

FIRST 90 DAYS — JUST DO THIS

- □ Today: write your honest inventory — what have you actually run, fixed, or grown?
- □ Days 1–30: pick the niche your experience supports; study its consulting market.
- □ Days 31–60: method study underway; first case-study write-ups from your own record.
- □ Days 61–90: credential path chosen; one practice diagnostic delivered for proof.

 Day 90: the long ramp has begun with eyes open — expertise compounding, credentials in motion, proof collecting.

NEXT — MAKE IT PERSONAL

This roadmap is the same for everyone. Your life is not.

- Not sure this career fits YOU? Take the Big Career Test — 50 questions, your top-3 matches and one honest “probably NOT you”. → careerglitch.com/#test
- Already sure? Turn AI into Your Personal Career Mentor — a 2,300-word system that interviews you first, checks your hours, budget and deadline honestly, and builds YOUR plan into a Notion dashboard. → careerglitch.com/#prompt

★ DIAGNOSE BEFORE YOU PRESCRIBE. ★

CAREER GLITCH · Figures: Career Glitch profession base (medians and training ranges compiled from U.S. Bureau of Labor Statistics, Occupational Outlook Handbook ranges). Modeled bars are estimates around the base median. License and certification rules vary by state — verify with your state board before paying for any program.